

The Culture of Business, Finance and the Economy

Class 21 – 2 june

Dr. Juan M. del Nido
First semester 2026

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Business

The Fuzzy, Insane Math That's Creating So Many Billion-Dollar Tech Companies

Startups achieve astronomical valuations in exchange for protecting new investors

By [Sarah Frier](#) and [Eric Newcomer](#)
March 17, 2015 at 10:00 AM GMT-3

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Today

The invention of "Corporate Culture"

New Vogue: Company Culture

Editorial/Photo From Business Page

As the business world grows more competitive, the concept of corporate culture has become a buzzword. It is the set of values, beliefs, and behaviors that define a company's identity. This concept has become a key factor in the success of many companies, as it helps to attract and retain top talent, build a strong brand, and create a positive work environment.

Corporate culture is not just a buzzword, it is a reality. It is the way a company operates, the way it treats its employees, and the way it interacts with the public. It is the heart and soul of a company, and it is what sets it apart from its competitors.

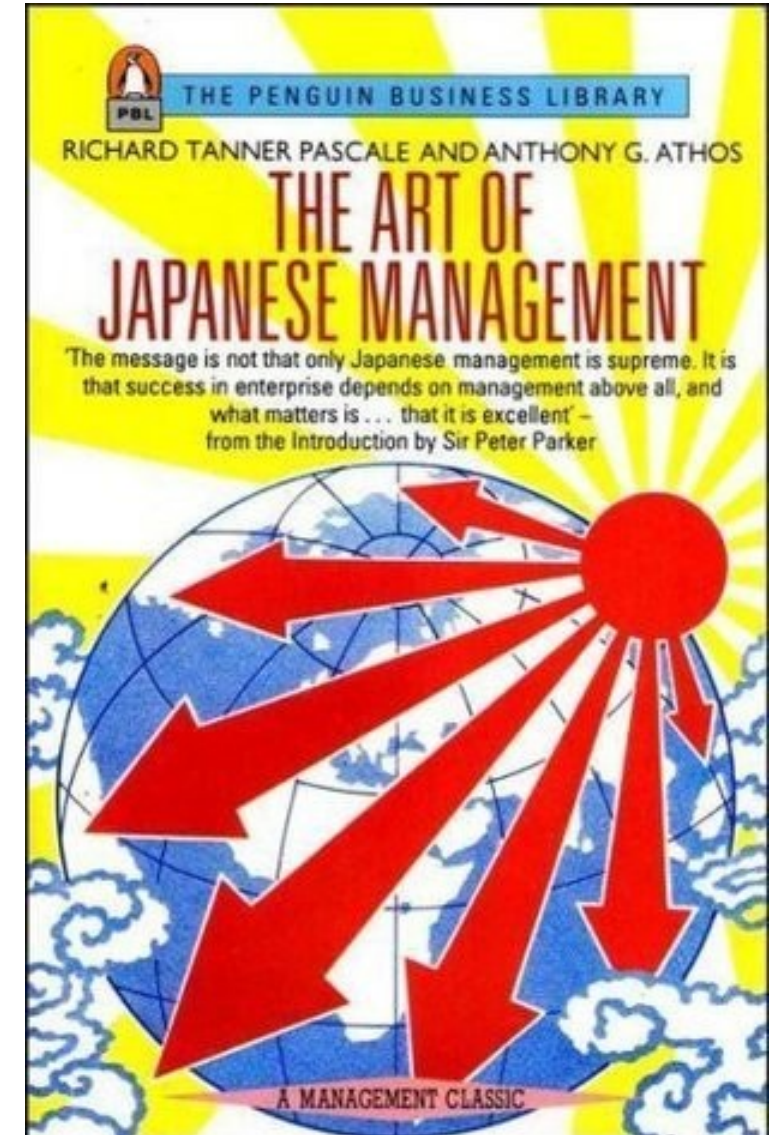
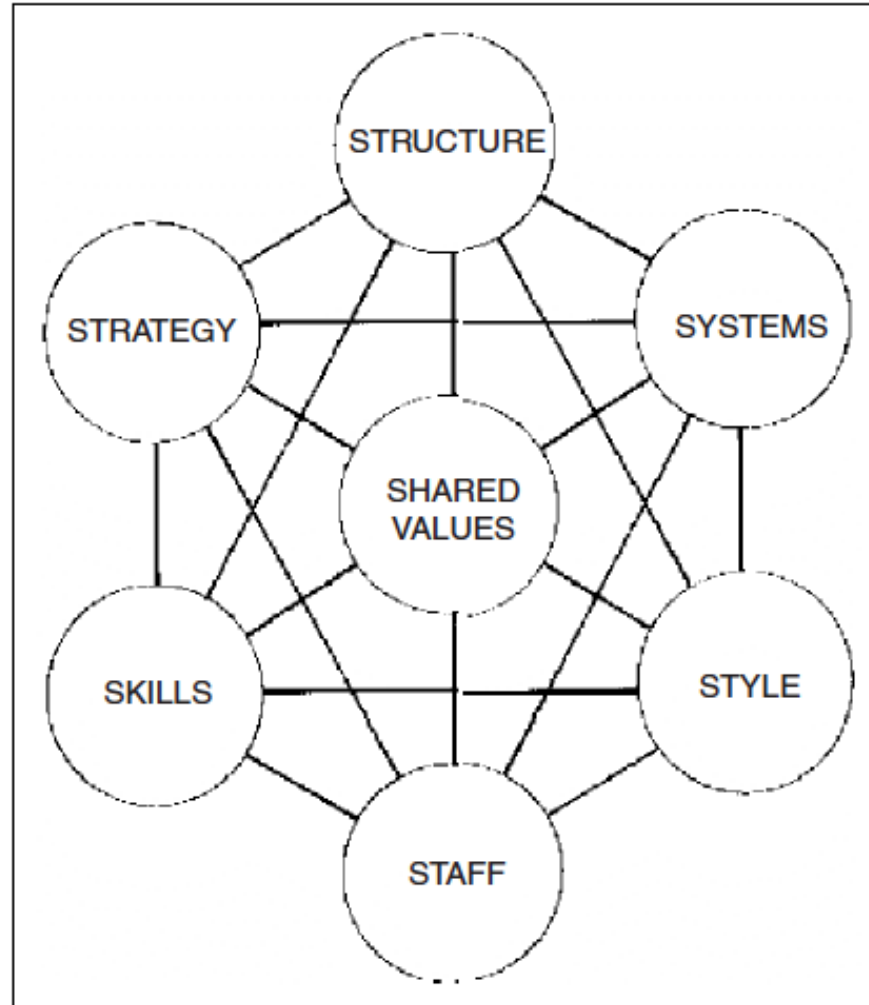
Many companies are now investing in corporate culture, as they realize that it is a key to long-term success. They are creating a strong sense of purpose, setting clear goals, and encouraging their employees to work together to achieve them. They are also creating a positive work environment, where employees are valued, respected, and given the opportunity to grow and develop.

Corporate culture is a powerful tool, and it is one that every company should have. It is the key to success in the business world, and it is the foundation of a strong and lasting company.

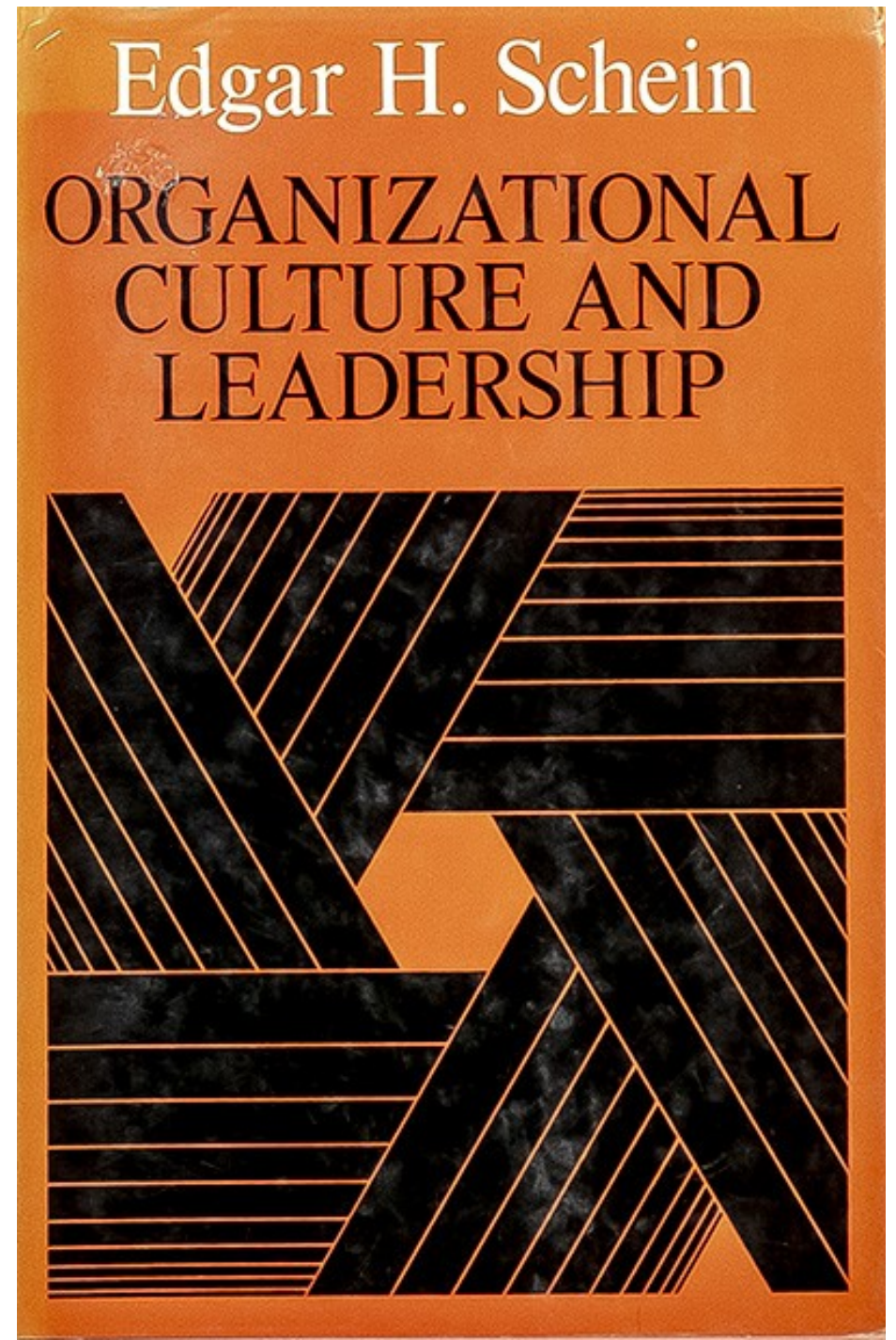
Corporate Culture: A Key to Success

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“a set of beliefs, values, and assumptions that are shared by members of an organization. They influence the behavior of organizational members, guiding decisions and behaviors”



Allegedly organizations' "culture" is a lever to be manipulated by management for improved performance. "Corporate culture" **allegedly** encompasses time-honoured values and behaviours that contribute to the unique environment of an organization, and **allegedly** a direct and causal relationship exists between a 'strong' culture and enhanced business performance. The assumption is that corporate culture has always existed in this way, but we only discovered it in the 1980s.

Our argument: it was invented as a "thing" in the 1980s and retrofitted into the past

Valores PwC

Nos guiamos por nuestros cinco valores. Ellos nos impulsan a alcanzar nuestras metas, manteniendo la excelencia y un óptimo ambiente laboral.

Las personas son el eje central de nuestros valores. Nuestro objetivo es estimular unos hábitos de comportamiento que respondan a nuestra ambición de ser líderes en la gestión de talento humano.

- Actuamos con integridad.
- Hacemos la diferencia.
- Nos interesamos.
- Trabajamos juntos.
- Reimaginamos lo posible.

These values are at the heart of what we stand for as a firm. They remain incredibly relevant, and each of us benefits from revisiting them regularly. This Code of Conduct supports our understanding and adherence to BCG's values in our daily interactions with clients, colleagues, the firm, and society as a whole.



- BCG VALUES
- INTEGRITY
 - DIVERSITY
 - PARTNERSHIP
 - SOCIAL IMPACT
 - VALUE DELIVERED
 - CLIENTS COME FIRST
 - RESPECT FOR THE INDIVIDUAL
 - THE STRATEGIC PERSPECTIVE
 - EXPANDING THE ART OF THE POSSIBLE



BCG

CODE OF CONDUCT

NEXT

PRINCIPLES

- BRING INSIGHT TO LIGHT
- DRIVE INSPIRED IMPACT
- CONQUER COMPLEXITY
- LEAD WITH INTEGRITY
- GROW BY GROWING OTHERS



Our Values

Effective Leadership

Abacus Jack Founder Andy Thomas started his career as an Officer in the Royal Navy. The importance of service, standards and effective leadership are at the heart of every decision we make as a business and are the cornerstone of our own values.

Honesty and Integrity

Clients need to trust their accountant. We fully understand this. We are one of the few accountancy firms who publish our fees online, so you have complete visibility of what we charge. Our job is to help you operate your business and tax affairs in compliance with UK Tax Laws. As such, we will be open and honest at all stages of service provision.

Service Excellence

We obsess over service and standards. This means we reply to emails and messages quickly, and all staff operate an online diary that is accessible to clients so you can book time with us when it's convenient for you. We also use a lot of automation to ensure you are reminded about key dates, deadlines and liabilities

Energy

Believe it or not, but we actually LOVE being accountants. Our clients are lovely people, often with these same values, and we love what we do. This means we deliver our services with energy, positivity and enthusiasm. We try and meet all our clients face to face where possible and the kettle is always on for a cuppa and catch up.



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Our Values

At Country Care Veterinary Center, our work is guided by a steadfast commitment to these core values:

- **Compassion** – We treat every animal as if it were our own and every client like a neighbor.
- **Kindness** – In every interaction, we lead with patience, empathy, and a sincere desire to help.
- **Integrity** – We believe in honest conversations, practical solutions, and doing what's right—even when it's not easy.
- **Affordability** – We strive to make excellent veterinary care accessible without compromising quality.
- **Community** – We serve the people and animals of our rural region with pride, building lasting relationships based on trust and respect.
- **Excellence** – We pursue continuous learning and clinical excellence, blending modern medicine with time-tested common sense.



Our Core Values:

Accountability: We acknowledge and accept responsibility for actions, products, decisions, time and policies.

Commitment: We are committed to providing opportunities for employees to grow personally, professionally and spiritually while consistently providing products of exceptional quality and an outstanding customer service experience.

Community: We actively support our community, donating our product and time to the specific needs of the organizations, neighborhoods and families we serve.

Integrity: We provide honest, timely communication and service that shows respect and kindness with every customer, teammate, supplier, governing agency and competitor.

Safety: We ensure the health and well-being of all teammates and customers. We create a safe work environment through ACT: Awareness, Communication and Training.

Teamwork: We strive to create a positive work environment by building a spirit of cooperative effort among individuals and departments; realizing our success depends on our ability to perform as one successful team.



Somos una Empresa familiar con más de 30 años en el mercado inmobiliario, estamos ubicados en el barrio de Caballito, inscriptos con la matrícula N° 2760 de CUCICBA - Néstor Rubén Varela.

Realizamos operaciones de compra, venta y alquiler en todo el ámbito de la Ciudad Autónoma de Buenos Aires.

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Brindar un servicio profesional y responsable de intermediación en la compra, venta y alquiler de inmuebles, nuestra premisa es el trato personalizado con el objetivo de satisfacer al cliente atendiendo, comprendiendo y trabajando sobre sus necesidades inmobiliarias específicas, y aportando valor a los inversores en bienes raíces.

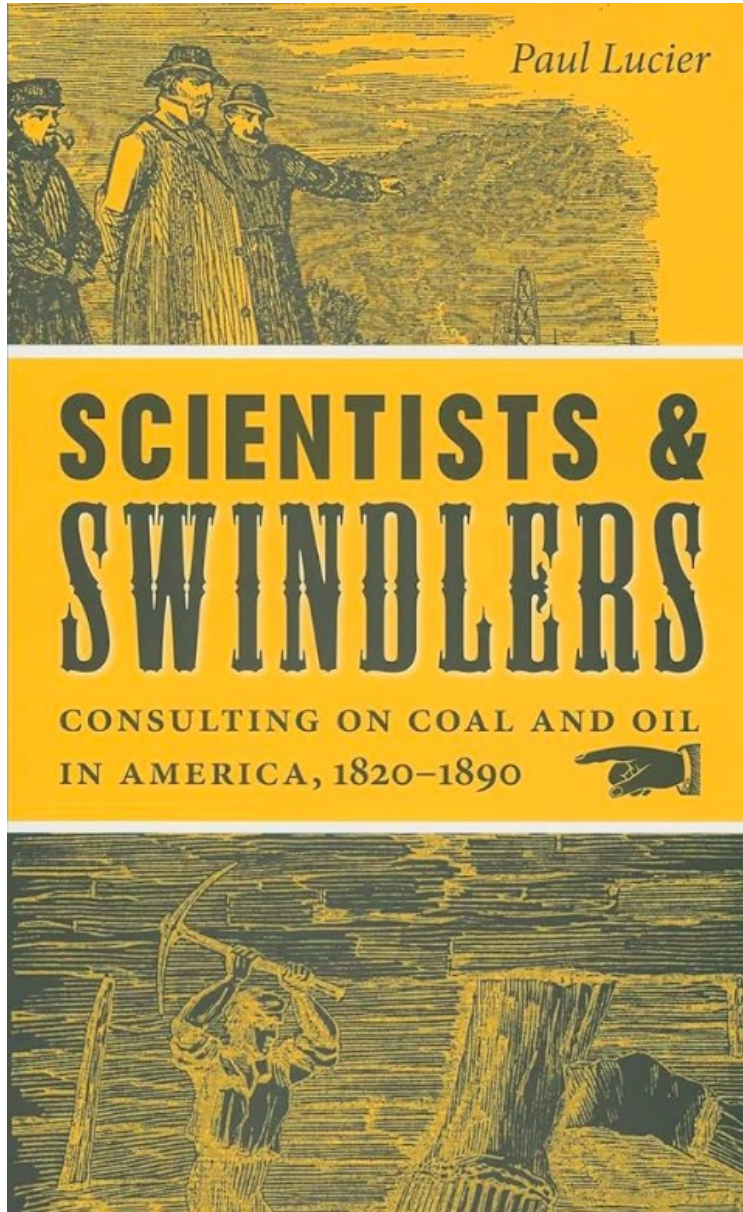
Nuestra Visión:

Ser una empresa líder en servicios inmobiliarios, referente absoluto de profesionalismo y atención personalizada.

Nuestros Valores:

- *Compromiso*
- *Integridad*
- *Profesionalismo*

The real story: picking up where we left off



**Engineers, accountants, untrained
businessmen, lawyers...**

No “mass” business schools

**How to consolidate a distinct professional
outlook?**

Medicine?

rooted in science, and perceived as both ethical and discrete.

**“Doctors of Management,” Fortune (July 1944),
“Business Doctors,” The Wall Street Journal (22 May 1947);
“Doctors or Businessmen?” Mechanical Engineering (April 1947);
“What Makes Business Call in the Doctor?” BusinessWeek (11 December 1954):**

Subtext: the consultant as physician should only serve the truly ill.

Engineering and accounting?

Many consultants had their initial training in accounting or engineering. But leading engineering firms like Ford and accounting firms like Arthur Andersen already were consultants, this analogy blurred the distinctions between these separated professional fields.

Law!

McKinsey & Company's brochure from 1940:

"we serve business on management problems like larger law firms serve them on legal problems."

Lawyers were highly trained, well paid, and discreet, and corporations had already acknowledged lawyers' value. Executives expected to grant lawyers, far more than other professionals, access to the corporate boardroom.

Mimicking law's ways

Before the 1950s, no uniform route for finding consultants and promoting staff. McKinsey hired in an ad hoc fashion from “industry, trade, and finance.”

McKinsey & Co. institutionalised hiring by mimicking large corporate law firms – a specific large corporate law firm.



CRAVATH, SWAINE & MOORE LLP

Only a few top graduates from elite law schools, trained on a fixed salary with the understanding that only a few of them would progress to partnership. Those who did not become partners would eventually have to leave.

In 1953 McKinsey started recruiting directly from Harvard Business School.

In 1954, they adopted an “up-or-out” policy.

Many of those “separated” remained loyal to McKinsey after their departure. These “alumni” were highly sought after by client companies filling staff positions...

... and by other consultancies.

The homogenization and standardization of consulting as a profession and as a business environment

**1970s – the largest and most profitable in
the world**

ARTHUR
ANDERSEN
& CO,

BCG

THE BOSTON CONSULTING GROUP

April 15, 1979

After the Strike: The Big Truckers Are Getting Bigger

Pay Hikes Added To Fuel Costs Spur Buy-Outs

By ROBERT WELLS

During the 1970s, the trucking industry has been a hotbed of activity. It has seen the rise of a new kind of trucking company, the "owner-operator," and the rise of a new kind of trucking company, the "lease-purchase" company.

But now, as the industry begins to recover from the recession, it is facing a new set of challenges. One of the most significant is the rise in fuel costs, which has led to a sharp increase in the cost of operating a truck.

Another major challenge is the rise in wages for truck drivers. This has led to a sharp increase in the cost of operating a truck, and has led to a sharp increase in the cost of operating a truck.

These challenges have led to a sharp increase in the cost of operating a truck, and have led to a sharp increase in the cost of operating a truck.

As a result, many trucking companies are looking for ways to reduce their costs. One way to do this is by buying out their drivers, which would allow them to control their own destiny.

By JOHN HENNING

Early in June, at New York's New York City, the Boston Consulting Group will conduct its annual conference for chief executive officers. The quality of the group is the chief executives of major American corporations. The group is made up of about 100 people, and is one of the most important groups in the business world.

One of the main topics of the conference will be the future of the American economy. The group will discuss the challenges facing the American economy, and will offer suggestions for how to overcome these challenges.

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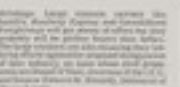
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Winning the Game With a Hot Theory

Companies Seek Advice of Boston Consulting Group

By JOHN HENNING

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From top left, chief executive of The Boston Consulting Group, John Henning; chief executive of The Boston Consulting Group, John Henning; chief executive of The Boston Consulting Group, John Henning; chief executive of The Boston Consulting Group, John Henning.

In Diversity, a Signal Success

A Conglomerate Run With A Loose Rein

The story is the same. The company is a conglomerate, and it is run with a loose rein. The company is a conglomerate, and it is run with a loose rein. The company is a conglomerate, and it is run with a loose rein.

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When he founded BCG with no more than a desk and a phone, Mr. Henderson began to devise the “experience curve”, or the “learning curve,” and he believes it applies, with the inexorability of law, to the costs of producing anything.

The idea is that the more “experience” a company has in making a product, the lower its costs will be. Thus, if Company A has twice the market share of Company B - that is, if it is producing twice as much of any product - its “experience” will be greater, its costs lower and its rate of profit higher.

“B.C.G. ideas have currency among senior managers and corporate planners. The president of Texas Instruments, J. Fred Bucy, lectured shareholders last year on the “learning curve.” He has also persuaded Rockwell International (and) corporations like the Eaton Corporation, American Standard, Black & Decker, CP International and General Foods.”

By specializing in strategy analysis, Mr. Henderson picked one of the fastest growing areas of consulting. Today he is far out front in the race with McKinsey & Company, long the dominant force in management consulting.

McKinsey enjoys steady trade in older consulting topics as reorganization studies and cost reduction programs.

“B.C.G. has clearly taken the initiative way from McKinsey”. “The strategy area as we know it today didn't exist 10 years ago. McKinsey got blind-sided. They didn't see this coming.”

Nowadays, B.C.G. is anywhere from two to three times the size of McKinsey in corporate strategy consulting.

Break

McKinsey strikes back

Tom Peters, Consultant, McKinsey

Rob Waterman, Consultant, McKinsey

Richard Pascale, Harvard Business School

Anthony Athos, Harvard Business School

The 'culture concept has been borrowed from anthropology' (Smircich, Concepts of Culture and Organizational Analysis, 1983, p.339)

Athos and Pascale's research on Japanese management and Terrence Deal and Allan Kennedy's work on "the rites and rituals of corporate life," would constitute the theoretical basis of "corporate culture."

Business Horizons

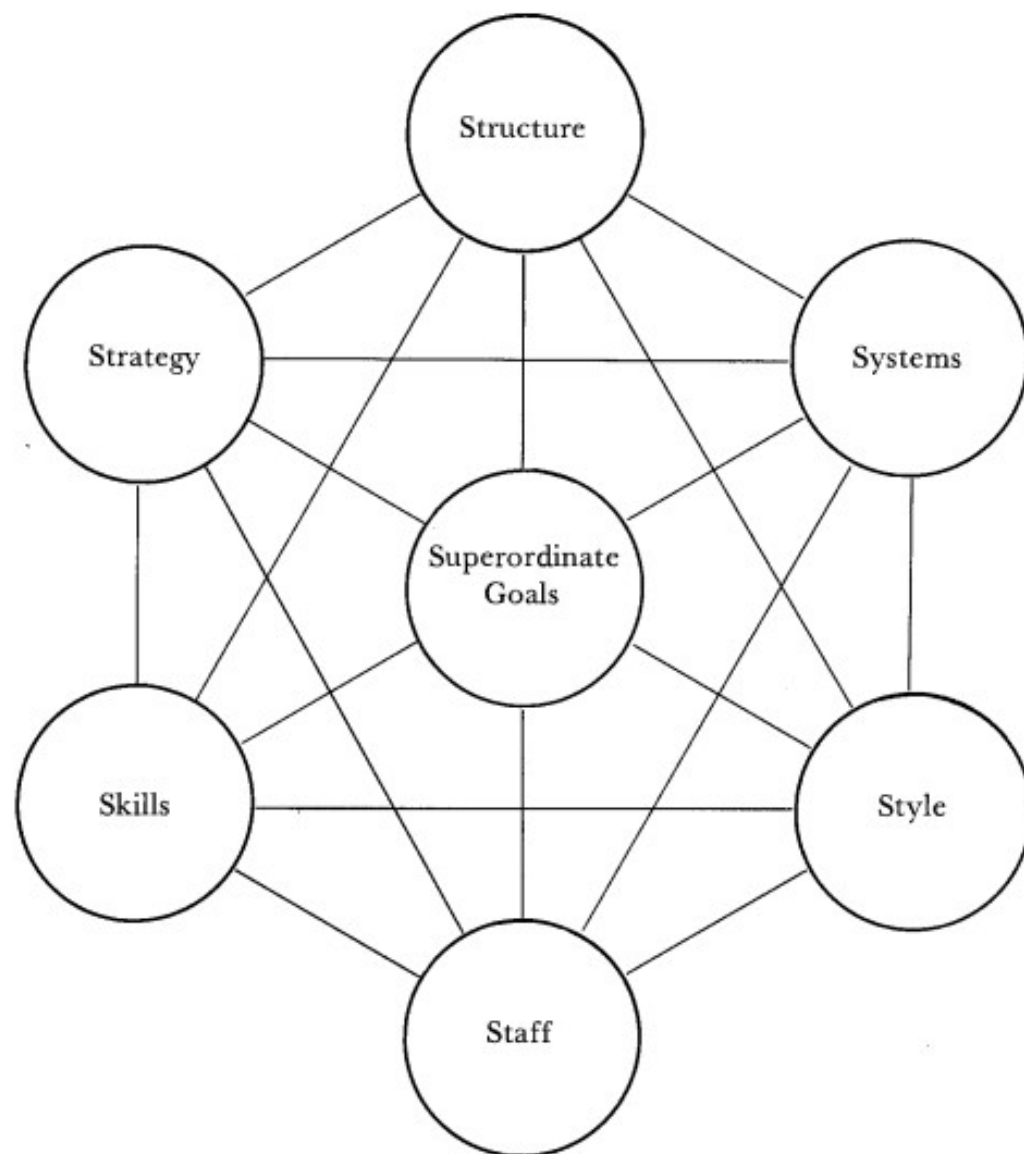
Volume 23, Issue 3, June 1980, Pages 14-26

STRUCTURE IS NOT ORGANIZATION

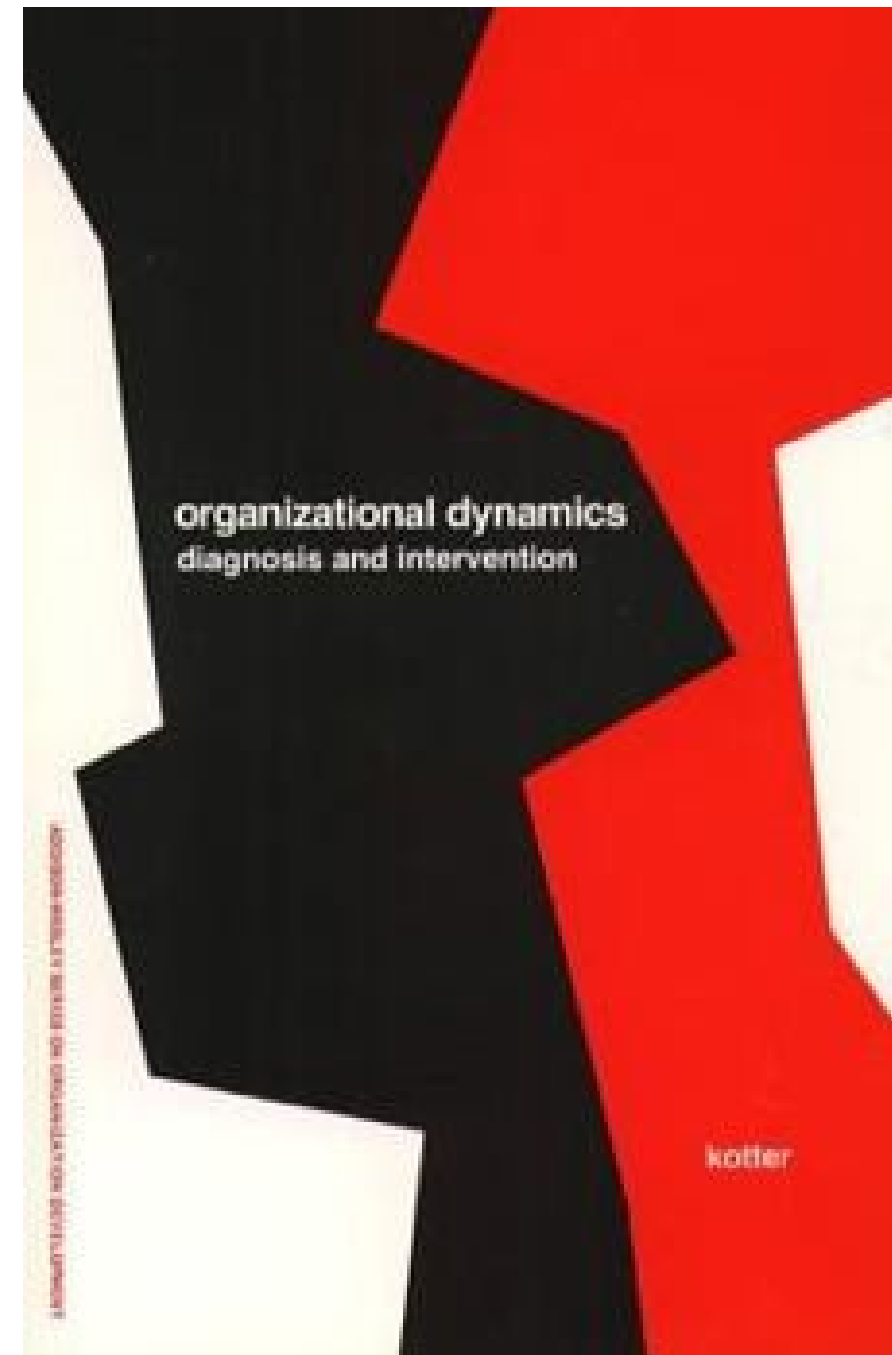
Diagnosing and solving organizational problems means looking not merely to structural reorganization for answers but to a framework that includes structure and several related factors.

ROBERT H. WATERMAN, JR., THOMAS J. PETERS, AND JULIEN R. PHILLIPS

A New View of Organization



Where did the Seven Ss model in the distinctive seven-node snowflake diagram come from? Pascal, Athos, Peters and Waterman have been a little vague about this. But a few years ago, we found a small monograph called *Organizational Dynamics* written by J.P. Kotter (1978). Kotter was also a professor at Harvard at the time these meetings took place and in his 1978 monograph, there is a series of diagrams that bear a striking resemblance to the Seven Ss – although some of the names of the nodes would be altered so they all started with S (e.g., Systems remained, but Employees became ‘Staff’ and Organizational Arrangements became ‘Structure’), providing the consultants with the catchy title for the framework.



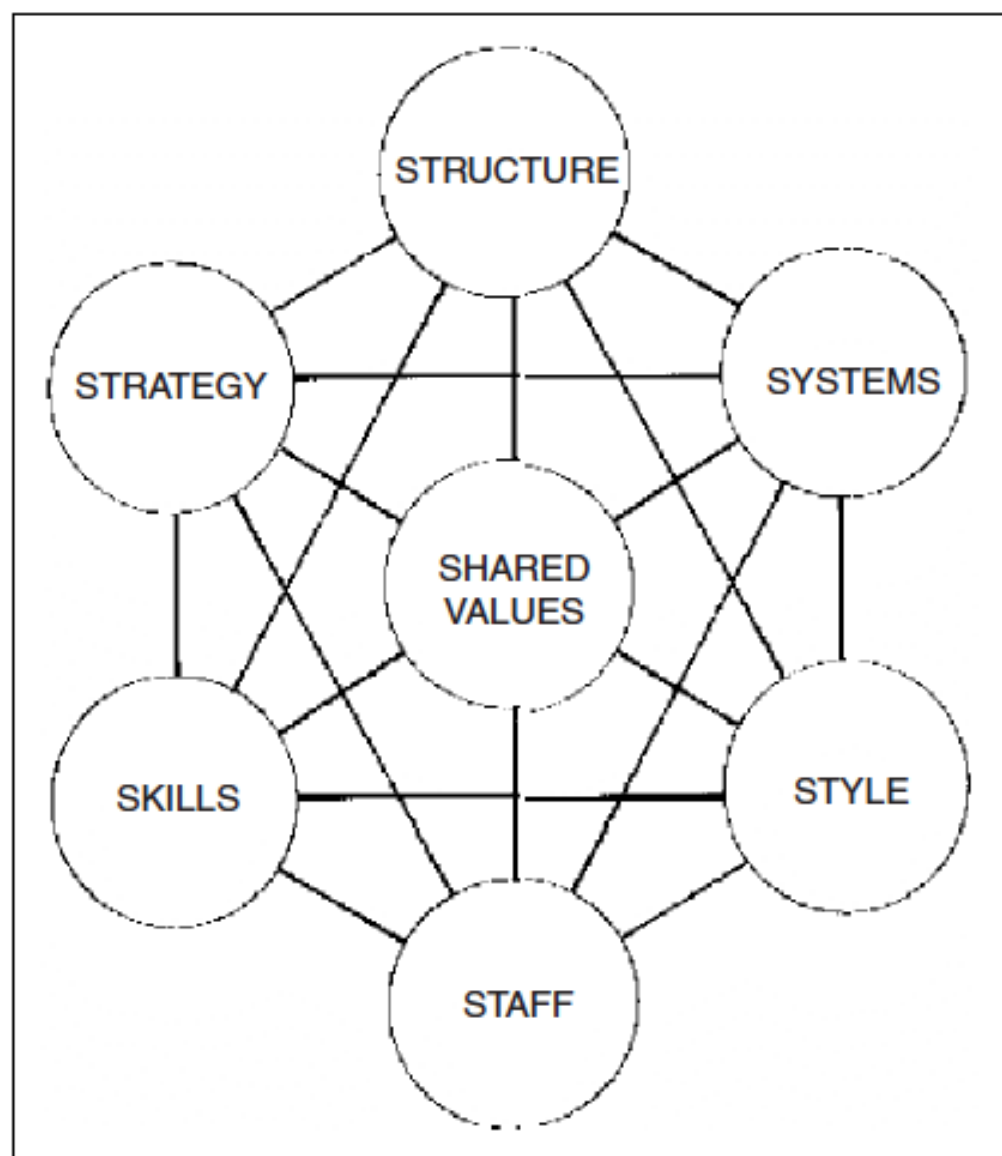


Figure 8.1. McKinsey's 7-S© framework. Reproduced with permission of McKinsey & Company.

**TOM PETERS &
ROBERT H. WATERMAN JR**

in
search
of **excellence**

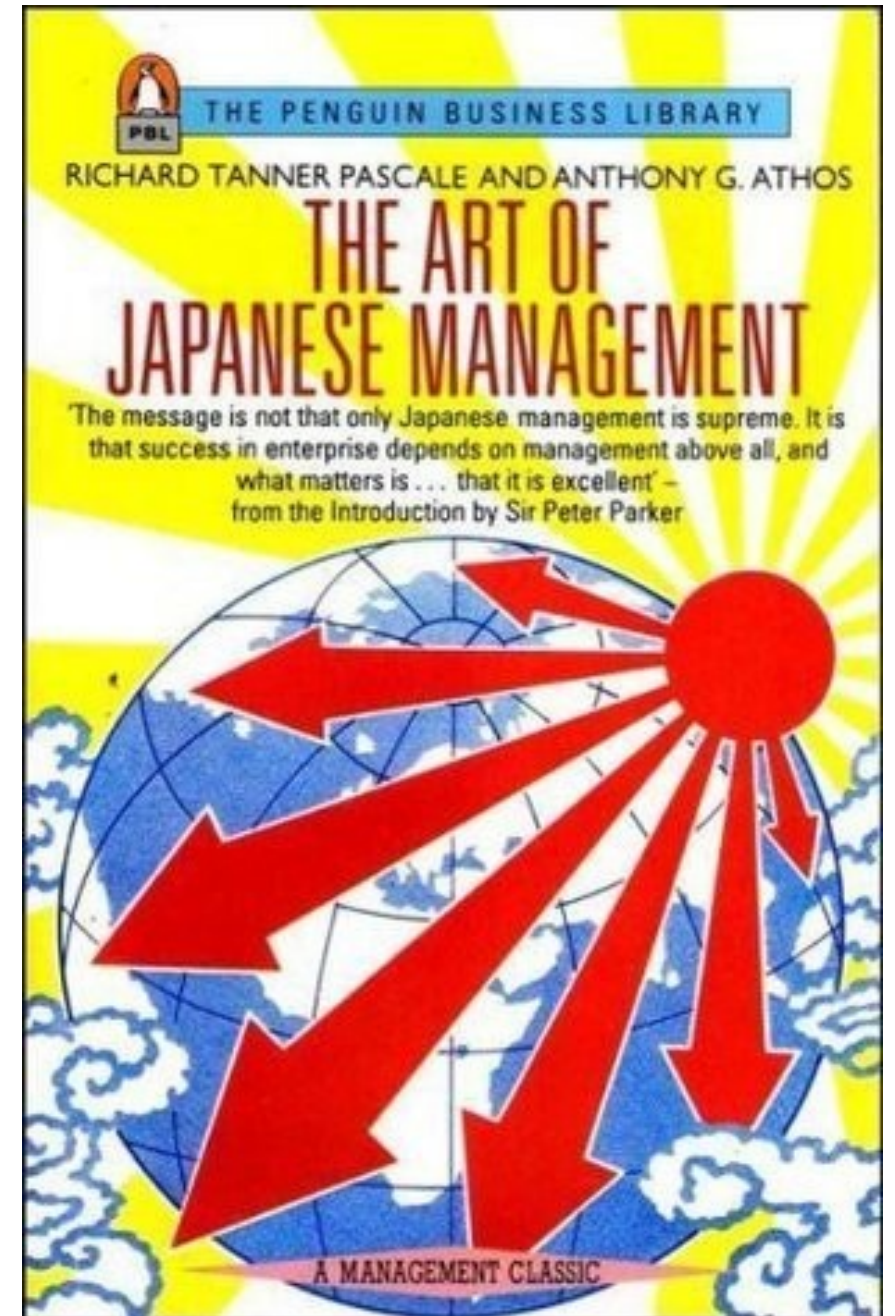
Lessons from
America's Best-Run Companies

WITH NEW MATERIAL

Corporate Cultures

The Rites and Rituals of Corporate Life

Terrence E. Deal and Allen A. Kennedy



**Obvious, trite, glib,
nonstarters**

What are they **really there
for?
(personal brand)**

Legitimise top-down, systemic, (unpleasant?) change

Culture's role in enabling organizational change



“The survey points to the need for companies to take a more holistic approach to change and to find ways to work with and within the organization’s culture during change initiatives”

The role of organizational culture in change management

How is culture linked to change and transformation?

As discussed, you're almost guaranteed to make some strategy adjustments in the near future, either voluntarily or because you're forced to. Your culture will drive the success or failure of those change efforts.

People resist change when they work in suboptimal cultures. If your team members are too attached to your current systems and tools and prefer to cling to the old pre-COVID ways of doing things, that's a culture issue, not a strategy issue.

The combination of a mediocre strategy and a strong culture is more conducive to change than having a mediocre culture and a strong strategy.

Managing employees: discipline, surveillance, compliance, training, promotions

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Total employees

2,409 ↑ 23%

6,208

2,457

HR's role in promoting core workplace values

Promoting a company's values is a key [HR function](#) that allows you to add significant value to your organization. HR's role in promoting core workplace values includes the following responsibilities:

- **Hiring:** Include core values in job descriptions and interview questions to give candidates an indication of what's essential to your company. This can increase your chances of attracting talent aligned with those values.
- **Onboarding:** Introduce values early and explain their relevance in day-to-day work to help new hires better understand company culture, give their work greater meaning, and highlight the importance of embodying such values.

Why are core values necessary in the workplace?

Core values in the workplace are necessary for the following reasons:

- **Consistency and trust:** When your workforce knows what the company stands for, they can trust that decisions are made thoughtfully and fairly. As such, there's less second-guessing, and staff feel more secure in their roles.
- **Stronger employee alignment and performance:** Employees who connect with organizational values and understand their role in the company's bigger picture are more likely to be engaged and collaborative.
- **Conflict resolution and prevention:** Strong core values provide a solid basis for resolving disagreements. These values can offer direction in conflict, challenges, and uncertainty.
- **Improved reputation and [employer brand](#):** Having strong core values and living up to them helps your company build a stronger, more authentic brand, which can attract and retain more top talent.

- **Training and development:** Reinforce values through ongoing learning programs. Interactive training can help employees better understand the company's core values and why they matter in their daily job activities.
- **Performance management:** Define goals and expectations and recognize and reward behaviors aligned with values. This will help reinforce core values, increase staff morale and performance, and motivate and engage employees.
- **Culture leadership:** Model the values yourself. It's critical to lead by example and champion leaders who do the same. If employees don't see their leaders modeling the values, they are unlikely to do so themselves.

HR's top burning question

How can I measure whether core values are influencing employee behavior and decisions?

AIHR's Lead Subject Matter Expert, Dr Marna van der Merwe, says: "You can use a combination of observation, feedback, and performance data. Here are some ways to do it:

- **Behavior-based 360° feedback:** Incorporate value-based behaviors into performance reviews and peer feedback. For example, if integrity is a core value, include prompts like "Does this employee make ethical decisions, even under pressure?"
- **Values-aligned recognition:** Track who is recognized (formally or informally) and why. Are employees being praised for actions that reflect core values?
- **Pulse surveys and other employee feedback surveys:** Include targeted questions like "Do you see our values in action daily?" or "What values are actually rewarded here?" Compare this feedback over time to spot trends or gaps.
- **Internal communication and employee stories:** Observe what stories are shared internally. Are they reinforcing values? If not, this signals a disconnect worth addressing.

Keeping the entrepreneurial self going: something to measure

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1. Gamify Your Core Values

Who doesn't love a little fun at work? Inject some playfulness into your values by gamifying them. Here's how:

Create a Values-Based Scavenger Hunt: Imagine a scavenger hunt where employees have to solve puzzles or complete tasks that relate to your core values. For example, if teamwork is one of your values, create challenges that can only be solved through collaboration.

Digital Badges or Points System: Create a system where employees earn points or digital badges when they exemplify a core value. You can build a leaderboard or even offer small rewards like extra time off or company swag for employees who consistently live the values.

This approach not only reinforces your values but also boosts engagement and healthy competition.

4. Design Value-Themed Challenges

Want to get your team excited? Challenge them! Set up monthly or quarterly challenges where teams compete to show how they can best live a particular core value.

Departmental Competitions: Let's say "innovation" is one of your values. Set up a competition where each department presents their most innovative idea to improve operations. Reward the best idea with a prize, or better yet, implement it.

"Core Values Champion" Award: Create a rotating award that highlights one employee who went above and beyond in representing the company's values. Each month, the winner can display a trophy or badge at their desk, gaining a bit of recognition and bragging rights.

Getting rid of people

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Yes.

Values-based Firing



Gokul Rajaram

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“We had to let him go because his behavior was contrary to our values,” the CEO said. “One of our most cherished values is collaboration; being open to ideas and input from every person in the company. Kent just didn’t get it. He came from a command-and-control environment, and was dismissive of anyone who was not an executive or a peer of his. He didn’t listen to people or take them seriously, even his own team members. People would go to him with ideas, and would come out feeling completely stonewalled and disrespected. We got several complaints about this, and I gave him tough feedback twice, once after each month. Unfortunately, his behavior didn’t change as a result of the feedback, so I had to fire him after month 3.”

Termination of Employment

Dear Donkia J

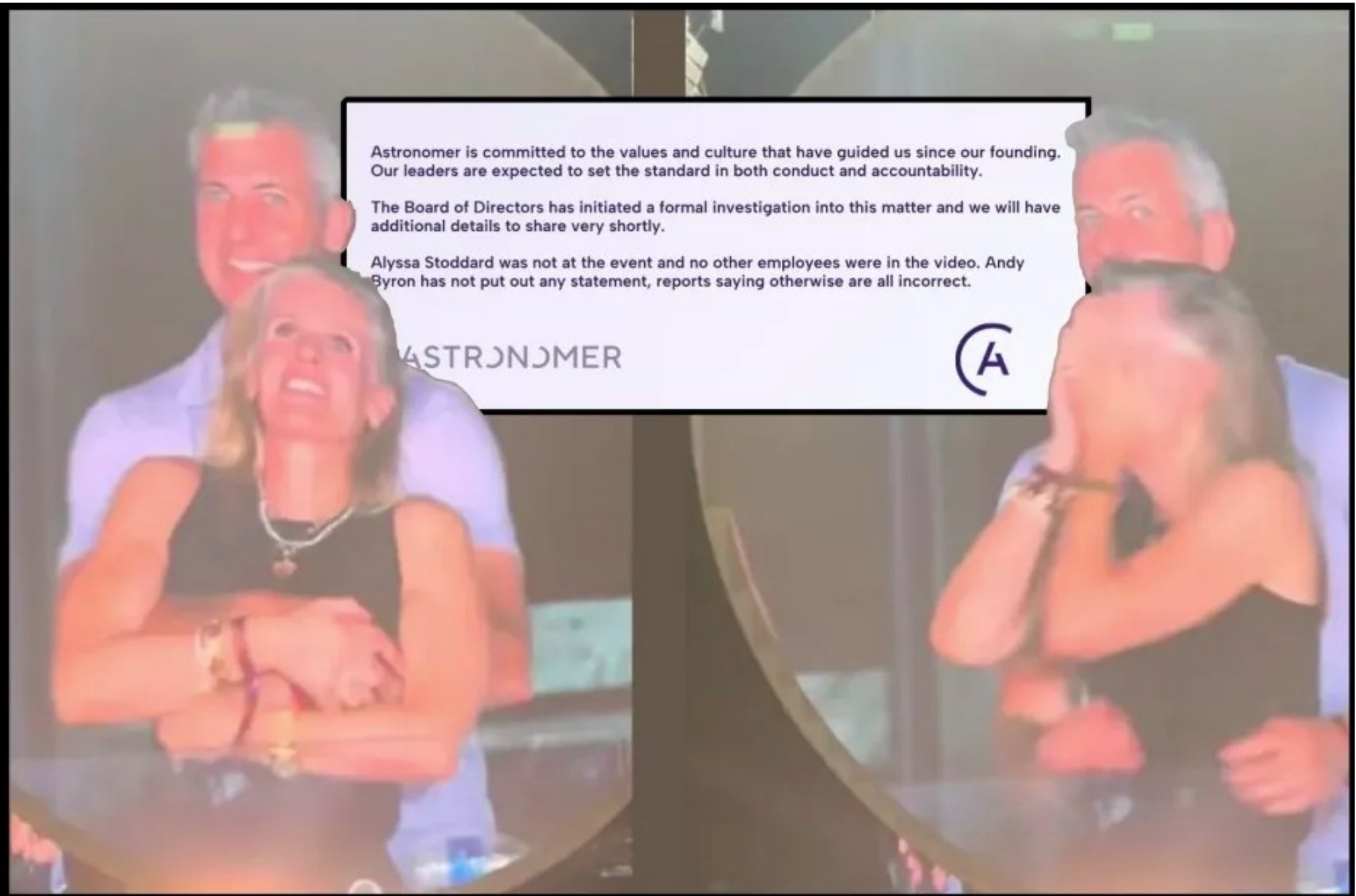
Please be advised that we are terminating your employment effective immediately.

This decision comes as a result of the content you posted on social media, which we deem to be inappropriate and not in alignment with the values of our nursing institution.

You are required to return any company property in your possession as soon as possible.

Sincerely,

Mista
HR Manager



Astronomer is committed to the values and culture that have guided us since our founding. Our leaders are expected to set the standard in both conduct and accountability.

The Board of Directors has initiated a formal investigation into this matter and we will have additional details to share very shortly.

Alyssa Stoddard was not at the event and no other employees were in the video. Andy Byron has not put out any statement, reports saying otherwise are all incorrect.

ASTRONOMER



Conclusion

**The ethicisation of company
relations**